

Challenge :	The Marauder's Map
Category :	OSINT (Open Source Intelligence) ,Digital Forensics
Difficulty :	Moderate
Tools used :	Chrome browser, Google Maps , Nmap , Exif

Summary

This challenge involves analyzing an image to uncover hidden information not visible at first glance. By extracting the image's metadata using tools like ExifTool, the player finds embedded GPS coordinates. These coordinates are then used in a map service to locate the exact real-world building. The final step is to identify the correct, full name of that location and submit it in the required format

Problem Statement

During a sweep of intercepted communications, the Department of Magical Law Enforcement recovered a single photograph suspected to be a dead drop left by Snape.

The image itself reveals only a facade, yet digital scrying suggests the author embedded precise geographic anchors deep within its invisible structures.

If a tracker were to extract these spatial coordinates and map them to their true physical counterpart, they might uncover the exact building where the fragment is hidden.

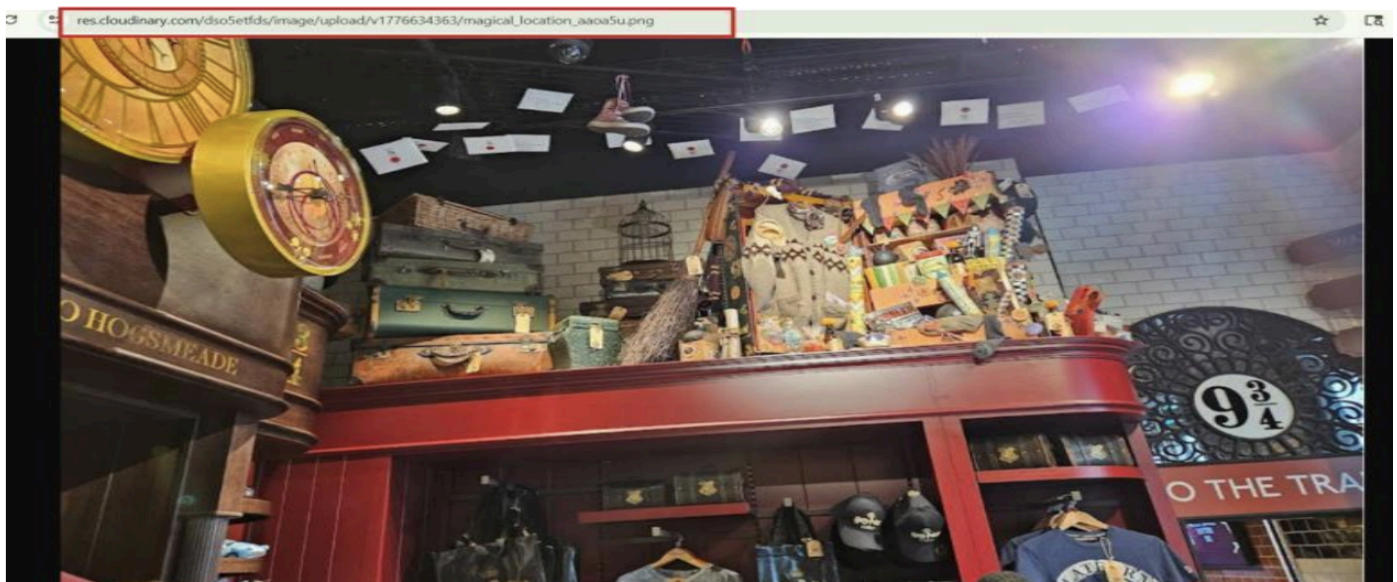
However, the Map's verification ward is strict. It demands absolute mathematical precision alongside the location's true, unabbreviated name.

To declare your findings, establish a **network conduit** directly to 80.225.207.209 using portal 9001. Extract the anchors. Name the destination. Prove that you know exactly where to look.

Steps to solve

Step 1: Download the image

- Open the given link
- Save the file as magical_location.png on your system



Step 2: Install a metadata tool

- Download and install ExifTool
- This tool helps you read hidden data inside images

ExifTool by Phil Harvey
Read, Write and Edit Meta Information!

Also available --> [Utility to fix Nikon NEF images corrupted by Nikon software](#)

Note: IP's that access web pages too quickly will be blocked, and I have had to get even more strict about blocking access to the forum to help deal with a plague of badly-behaving AI bots. Send an IP address to exiftool@gmail.com if you think you have been wrongly denied access.

Installing Tag Names Resources History Forum FA

(To reduce load on the exiftool.org server, the download links now point to SourceForge)

--> [Click here for the checksums of all distribution packages.](#)

[Download Version 13.57 \(7.9 MB\) - Apr. 17, 2026](#)

ExifTool is a platform-independent Perl library plus a command-line application for reading, writing and editing meta information in a wide variety of files. ExifTool supports many different metadata formats including EXIF, GPS, IPTC, XMP, JFIF, GeoTIFF, ICC Profile, Photoshop IRB, FlashPix, AECF and ID3, Lyrics3, as well as the maker notes of many digital cameras by Apple, Canon, Casio, DJI, FLIR, FujiFilm, GE, Google, GoPro, HP, JVC/Victor, Kodak, Leaf, Minolta/Konica-Minolta, Motorola, Nikon, Nintendo, Olympus/Epson, Panasonic/Leica, Pentax/Asahi, Phase One, Reconyx, Ricoh, Samsung, Sanyo, Sigma/Foveon and Sony.

ExifTool is also available as a Windows executable and a MacOS package: (Note that these versions contain the executable only, and do not include the HTML documentation or other files of the full distribution above.)

Windows 32-bit: [exiftool-13.57_32.zip \(11.4 MB\)](#)
64-bit: [exiftool-13.57_64.zip \(11.2 MB\)](#)

The Windows executable archives include Perl. Just download and un-zip the appropriate archive then double-click on "exiftool(-k).exe" to read the application documentation, drag-and-drop files and

Step 3: Extract metadata

- Open terminal/command prompt in the image folder and Run:
`cd exiftool-13.57_32`
`.\exiftool.exe magical_location.png`

Step 4: Find GPS coordinates

- Look for:
- GPS Latitude
- GPS Longitude

```
PS C:\Users\JEEVANS\Downloads> .\exiftool-13.57_32> .\exiftool.exe magical_location.png
ExifTool Version Number      : 13.57
File Name                    : magical_location.png
Directory                    : .
File Size                     : 1534 kB
File Modification Date/Time   : 2026:05:02 21:23:09+05:30
File Access Date/Time        : 2026:05:02 21:23:34+05:30
File Creation Date/Time      : 2026:05:02 21:23:08+05:30
File Permissions              : -rw-rw-rw-
File Type                     : PNG
File Type Extension          : png
MIME Type                     : image/png
Image Width                   : 1237
Image Height                  : 750
Bit Depth                     : 8
Color Type                    : RGB with Alpha
Compression                   : Deflate/Inflate
Filter                        : Adaptive
Interlace                     : Noninterlaced
sRGB Rendering                : Perceptual
Gamma                         : 2.2
Pixels Per Unit X             : 4724
Pixels Per Unit Y             : 4724
Pixel Units                   : meters
Snip Metadata                 : [{"clipPoints":[{"x":0,"y":0}, {"x":1237,"y":0}, {"x":1237,"y":750}, {"x":0,"y":750}]}]
Exif Byte Order               : Big-endian (Motorola, MM)
Y Cb Cr Positioning           : Centered
GPS Version ID                 : 2.3.0.0
GPS Latitude Ref              : North
GPS Longitude Ref             : East
Image Size                    : 1237x750
Megapixels                    : 0.928
GPS Latitude                   : 30 deg 21' 15.72" N
GPS Longitude                  : 76 deg 22' 10.94" E
GPS Position                   : 30 deg 21' 15.72" N, 76 deg 22' 10.94" E
PS C:\Users\JEEVANS\Downloads> .\exiftool-13.57_32> cd ..
PS C:\Users\JEEVANS\Downloads>
```

Step 6: Locate on map

- Open Google Maps
- Paste coordinates
- Zoom in and click the building

